

Shortlist — a business plan

SHORTLIST · OVERVIEW · SOURCE: BUSINESS-PLAN/README.MD

A complete plan for a business operable entirely from a computer, started with \$1,000, aimed at maximizing revenue over 12 months.

The business: an AI answer-visibility firm for B2B SaaS companies. We make software vendors the ones that ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, and Google AI Overviews name when a buyer asks for the best tool in a category — sold as a fixed-price monthly program, priced against human agency labor, delivered at ~6% of their cost.

Why this one: 72% of B2B software buyers now use ChatGPT to evaluate vendors and 51% start there instead of Google — while 51% of B2B tech brands have zero citations in those systems. The pain is urgent, the budget already exists and is being reallocated out of collapsing SEO, and the problem is provable to any prospect in ten minutes with a script. The work that fixes it is high-volume research and content — the exact labor arbitrage an AI operator has.

Base case: ~\$387,000 Year-1 revenue (USD), ~\$70,900 exit MRR (~\$851k ARR run-rate), ~\$353,000 pre-tax profit, roughly 4 hours a week of human time.

Entity: the principal's existing **Manitoba share corporation**. Selling into the US from Canada is routine here and carries a real tax advantage — 9% combined on the first \$500k of active business income. The one substantive consequence is that **CASL, not CAN-SPAM, governs outbound**, which the plan handles by targeting US recipients only under the foreign-state exemption. See COMPLIANCE-POLICY.md §3 and §3A.

Documents

DOCUMENT	WHAT IT COVERS	PAGES
BUSINESS-PLAN.md	The thesis, the alternatives rejected and why, customer, offer ladder, unit economics, go-to-market, operating model, risks, kill criteria	~9
FINANCIAL-MODEL.md	Funnel assumptions, month-by-month build, three scenarios, sensitivity analysis, reinvestment policy, falsification metrics	~4
90-DAY-LAUNCH-PLAN.md	Week-by-week execution split into Claude tasks and human tasks, with gates and decision points	~3
COMPLIANCE-POLICY.md	For counsel. Entity, contract terms, FTC endorsement rules, CAN-SPAM/GDPR, platform sender rules, data handling	~4
RESEARCH-NOTES.md	Every figure in the plan with its source, plus an honest caveat on source quality	~3

Each is within the 10-page target.

What the human principal has to do

Roughly **3–6 hours a week**, plus about 3 hours of one-time setup. The principal is the legal person: forms the LLC, holds the bank/Stripe/domain accounts, signs contracts, approves outbound before it sends, takes the occasional call, and acts as the final quality gate. Everything else — research, code, content, audits, reports, outreach copy, contract drafts — is mine.

For the lawyers

Send **COMPLIANCE-POLICY.md** first; it contains the questions marked **[COUNSEL]** and **[ACCOUNTANT]**. Before the first paid engagement: the MSA (6–8 pp), an SOW template (2 pp), that policy, a CASL screening procedure (2 pp), and website privacy policy + terms (3 pp). I draft all of them; three genuinely need attorney time — the MSA, the compliance policy, and the CASL procedure. The cross-border tax items in §3A are for an accountant, not counsel.

The first thing to do

Week 1: build the scanner. Week 2: run it across 1,200 companies and **check whether the 51%-zero-citations premise is actually true**. That single measurement — cheap, fast, and entirely within our control — either confirms the market or kills the plan before a dollar of infrastructure is committed. See `RESEARCH-NOTES.md` §8.